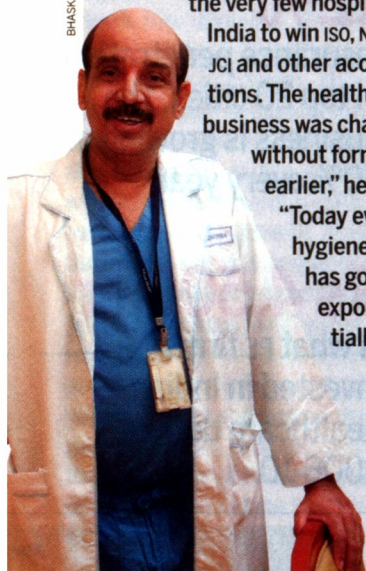


New Ethics

Dr Ramakanta Panda

Asian Heart Institute

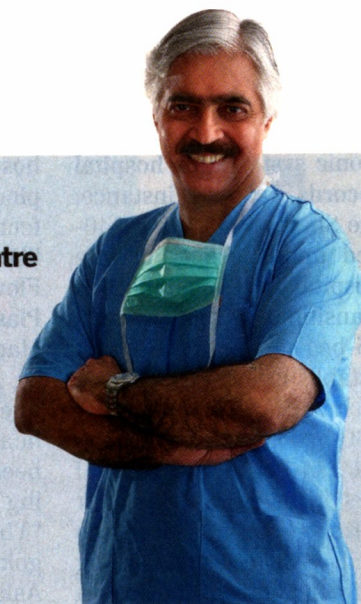
The 'Prime Minister's surgeon' wanted to replicate the model from the prestigious Cleveland Clinic, US, where he used to work. Today, Asian Heart Institute in Mumbai is one of the very few hospitals in India to win ISO, NABL and JCI and other accreditations. The healthcare business was chaotic and without format earlier," he says. "Today even hygiene value has gone up exponentially."



Dr Ashok Seth

Escorts Heart Institute and Research Centre

With his wide experience inside India and around the world, in public and private systems, Dr Seth, the man who heads Escorts hospital, understands the compulsions and restlessness of a market on a roll. "What the nation lacked so far was infrastructure," he says. "Indians spent money to go to unsanitary places or overseas. With the healthcare boom, as infrastructure comes into place, the private players need to keep one eye on the costs and another on quality," he points out.

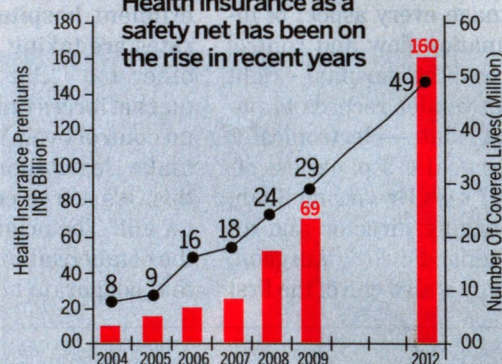


BHASKAR PAUL/www.indiatodayimages.com



Health Wise

Health insurance as a safety net has been on the rise in recent years



5-10
times higher salary
rates are being
offered by corporate
hospitals to doctors

63%
hospital CEOs think
getting trained
manpower will be a
challenge in future

29%
CEOs believe lack of
consistent policy
on accreditation
hinders growth

know. But a patient knows how much you care," laughs Seth.

"The private sector has not been able to take technology to the common man, although it has created phenomenal standards in the country," adds Hemant Khavle, hospital planner and a senior consultant with KJWW Engineering. "It is technology that forms the backbone of the paradigm shift in healthcare, but cost goes up as technology and treatment options increase," he puts it bluntly. The constant evolution of life-support systems, diagnostics, expensive third and fourth generation medicines and greater number of devices-related surgeries—all come

at a cost. "There are many hospitals which over equip themselves with technology," he says. "Where a 64-slice CT scanner is enough, people insist on buying 256-slice."

Healthcare as an industry is coming into its own. If wishes were horses, there would be third-party payers subsidising healthcare, laws compelling profit-making organisations to insure all employees, indigenous manufacturers developing cutting-edge technology, bodies standardising procedures and quality, corporates running sensible business models, doctors compulsorily treating patients free of cost one day a month, universal insurance at Re 1 a

day. There's more: the rich will patronise the private sector, the poor will flock to the public sector, while subsidised hospitals under public-private partnerships will provide quality healthcare to the rest at reasonable rates. That's the dream scenario but the new buzz in the air is contagious and the ambitious projects on the ground and in the pipeline point to an inescapable truism: health is wealth.

with inputs from Stephen David, Uday Mahurkar, Senthil Kumar, Nishika Patel, Harsha Bhat, Vanita Chitkara, Sharmi Ghosh Dastidar, Arvind Chhabra, Elora Sen, Amarnath Menon, Anand Natarajan, Nandini Vaish and Ayesha Singh